

were observed, and draws a contrasted picture of the true fast in which Jehovah delights, viz. deeds of philanthropy, unselfishness, liberality, and mercy : if Israel will devote itself to these works, and at the same time show a cheerful reverence towards its God (*v.* 13), then Jehovah will shower down His blessings upon it, and it will triumphantly resume possession of its ancient home. C. 59 the prophet represents the people as confessing the chief sins of which they have been guilty : unable to rescue themselves, Jehovah will now interpose on their behalf, and manifest Himself as a redeemer in Zion, not indeed to all without distinction, but to those who satisfy the needful moral conditions, and have "turned from rebellion in Jacob."

(3.) Here the prophet depicts, in still brighter hues, the felicity of the ideal Zion of the future. As before, a progress may be observed in the development of his thought. In c. 40—48, when Israel's release was foremost in his thoughts, the judgment was conceived as falling solely upon Israel's *foes* : in c. 57—59, however, he evinces a more vivid consciousness of Israel's sinfulness, and of the obstacle which that presents to the restoration of the *entire* nation ; and in the chapters which now follow, he announces a judgment to be enacted *in Israel* itself, distinguishing Jehovah's faithful "servants" (65, 8. 9. 13. 14. 15) from those disloyal to him, and excluding the latter from the promised blessings. C. 60 the longed for "light" (59, 9) bursts upon the prophet's eye : the dark cloud of night that shrouds the rest of the world has been lifted over the Holy City ; and he gathers the features belonging to Zion restored into a single dazzling vision. 61, 1—3 Jehovah's ideal Servant is once more introduced, describing the gracious mission entrusted to him, to "bring good tidings to the afflicted," and to "proclaim liberty to the captives" (*cf.* 42, 3. 7. 49, 9), which is followed, as before (49, 9—12), by the promise of Jerusalem's restoration (61, 4) : in the rest of c. 61—62 the prophet dwells upon the new and signal marks of Jehovah's favour, resting visibly upon the restored nation, and its own grateful appreciation (61, 10 f.) of the blessedness thus bestowed upon it. 63, 1—6 is a dramatic dialogue between Jehovah, depicted as a victor returning from Edom, and the prophet, in which, under the form of an ideal humiliation of nations, marshalled upon the territory of Israel's inveterate foe, is expressed the thought of Israel's triumph over its enemies.

The dialogue ended, the prophet's tone changes ; and 63, 7—64, 12, in the assurance that the redemption guaranteed by Jehovah's triumph will be wrought out, he supplies faithful Israel with a hymn of thanksgiving, supplication, and confession, expressive of the frame of mind worthy to receive it, and couched in a strain of surpassing pathos and beauty. C. 65 appears to be intended as an answer to the supplication of c. 64,—an answer, however, in which the distinction, alluded to above, is drawn between the worthy and unworthy Israelites. God has ever, He says, been accessible to His people, and ready to renew intercourse with them ; it was they who would not respond, but provoked Him with their idolatries. Israel, however, is not to be rejected on account of the presence within it of unworthy members : a seed of "chosen ones" will be brought out of Jacob, who shall again inherit the mountains of Palestine. A new order of things (*vi.* 17 ; cf. 51, 16) is about to be created, in which Jerusalem and her people will be to Jehovah a source of unalloyed delight, and in which care and disappointment will cease to vex. 66, 1—5 the prophet, in view probably of the anticipated restoration of the Temple, reminds the Jews that no earthly habitation is really adequate to Jehovah's majesty, and that His regard is to be won, neither by the magnificence of a material temple, nor by unspiritual service, but by humility and the devotion of the heart. He concludes, *vv.* 6—24, by two contrasted pictures of the glorious blessedness in store for Jerusalem, and the terrible judgment impending over her foes.

Authorship of c. 40—66. Three independent lines of argument converge to show that this prophecy is not the work of Isaiah, but, like 13, 2—14, 23, has for its author a prophet writing towards the close of the Babylonian captivity. (1) The *internal evidence* supplied by the prophecy itself points to this period as that at which it was written. It alludes repeatedly to Jerusalem as ruined and deserted (*e.g.* 44, 26^b. 58, 12. 61, 4. 63, 18. 64, 10 f.) ; to the sufferings which the Jews have experienced, or are experiencing, at the hands of the Chaldeans (42, 22. 25. 43, 28 [*R.V. marg.*]. 47, 6. 52, 5) ; to the prospect of return, which, as the prophet speaks, is imminent (40, 2. 46, 13. 48, 20 &c.). Those whom the prophet addresses, and, moreover, addresses *in person*—arguing with them, appealing to them, striving to win their assent by his warm and impassioned rhetoric (40, 21. 26. 28. 43,

10. 48, 8. 50, 10 f. 51, 6. 12 f. 58, 3 ff., &c.)—are not the men of Jerusalem, contemporaries of Ahaz and Hezekiah, or even of Manasseh; they are the exiles in Babylonia. Judged by the *analogy of prophecy*, this constitutes the strongest possible presumption that the author actually *lived* in the period which he thus describes, and is not merely (as has been supposed) Isaiah immersed in spirit in the future, and holding converse, as it were, with the generations yet unborn. Such an immersion in the future would be not only without parallel in the OT., it would be contrary to the nature of prophecy. The prophet speaks always, in the first instance, to his own contemporaries: the message which he brings is intimately related with the circumstances of his time: his promises and predictions, however far they reach into the future, nevertheless rest upon the basis of the history of his own age, and correspond to the needs which are then felt. The prophet never abandons his own historical position, but speaks from it. So Jeremiah and Ezekiel, for instance, predict first the exile, then the restoration; both are contemplated by them as still future; both are viewed from the period in which they themselves live. In the present prophecy there is no *prediction* of exile; the exile is not announced as something still future: it is *presupposed*, and only the *release* from it is *predicted*. By analogy, therefore, the author will have lived in the situation which he thus presupposes, and to which he continually alludes.

It is true, passages occur in which the prophets throw themselves forward to an ideal standpoint, and describe from it events future to themselves, as though they were past (e.g. 5, 13–15. 9, 1–6. 23, 1. 14); but these are not really parallel: the transference to the future, which they imply, is but *transient*; in the immediate context, the prophet uses future tenses, and speaks from his own standpoint (alluding, for instance, plainly to the events or circumstances of his own age); the expressions, moreover, are general, and the language is figurative. The writings of the prophets supply no analogy for such a *sustained* transference to the future as would be implied if these chapters were by Isaiah, or for the *detailed* and *definite* description of the circumstances of a distant age.

(2.) The argument derived from the historic function of prophecy is confirmed by the *literary style* of c. 40–66, which is very different from that of Isaiah. Isaiah shows strongly marked individualities of style: he is fond of particular images and phrases, many of which are used by no other writer of the OT. Now, in the chapters which contain evident allusions to the

age of Isaiah himself, these expressions occur repeatedly; in the chapters which are without such allusions, and which thus authorize *prima facie* the inference that they belong to a different age, *they are absent, and new images and phrases appear instead*. This coincidence cannot be accidental. The subject of c. 40—66 is not *so* different from that of Isaiah's prophecies (e.g.) against the Assyrians, as to necessitate a new phraseology and rhetorical form: the differences can only be reasonably explained by the supposition of a change of author. Isaiah in his earliest, as in his latest prophecies (c. 29—33; 37, 22—32, written when he must have been at least sixty years of age), uses the same style, and shows a preference for the same figures; and the change of subject in c. 40—66 is not sufficiently great to account for the marked differences which here show themselves, and which indeed often relate to points, such as the form and construction of sentences, which stand in no appreciable relation to the subject treated.

The following are examples of words, or forms of expression, used repeatedly in c. 40—66 (sometimes also in c. 13 f. and c. 34 f.), but never in the prophecies which contain independent evidence of belonging to Isaiah's own age:—

1. *To choose*, of God's choice of Israel: 41, 8. 9. 43, 10. 44, 1, 2 (cf. 42, 1. 49, 7, of the *ideal*, individualized nation); *my chosen*, 43, 20. 45, 4. 65, 9. 15. 22. So 14, 1.
2. *Praise* (subst. and verb: תהלה, הלל): 42, 8. 10. 12. 43, 21. 48, 9. 60, 6. 18. 61, 3. 11. 62, 7. 9. 63, 7. 64, 10.
3. *To shoot or spring forth* (צמח): 44, 4. 55, 10. 61, 11^a; esp. metaphorically—(a) of a moral state, 45, 8. 58, 8. 61, 11^b; (b) of an event manifesting itself in history (not so elsewhere), 42, 9. 43, 19.
4. *To break out* (פצה) *into singing*: 44, 23. 49, 13. 52, 9. 54, 1. 55, 12. Also 14, 7. Only Ps. 98, 4 besides.
5. *Pleasure* (הפנץ): (a) of Jehovah's purpose, 44, 28. 46, 10. 48, 14. 53 10; (b) of human purpose or business, 58, 3. 13. More generally, 54, 12. 62, 4.
6. *Good will* (God's) רצון: 49, 8. 56, 7. 58, 5. 60, 7. 10. 61, 2.
7. *Thy sons*—the pronoun being feminine and referring to Zion: 49, 17. 22. 25. 51, 20. 54, 13. 60, 4. 9. 62, 5; cf. 66, 8. Isaiah, when he uses the same word, always says *sons* absolutely, the implicit reference being to God (Dt. 14, 1): so 1, 2. 4. 30, 1. 9.
8. *To rejoice* (שחש): 61, 10. 62, 5. 64, 4. 65, 18. 19. 66, 10. 14. Also 35, 1.
9. The phrases, *I am Jehovah, and there is none else* (or *besides*): 45, 5. 6. 18. 21. 22; *I am the first, and I am the last*: 44, 6. 48, 12; cf. 41, 4; *I am thy God, thy Saviour*, &c.: 41, 10. 13. 43, 3. 48, 17^b.